

\$1M VSL WORKSHOP

The Workbook

Build a money-printing offer and sales video — step by step. Your complete fill-in-the-blanks playbook.

Part 1 · The Offer Engine

Part 2 · The VSL

How to use this workbook



Download or print this workbook so you can fill it in as you go.



Watch Lesson 1 first.

Before you fill anything in, watch the first video of your workshop — it walks you through exactly how to use this workbook. Then come back and work through it step by step.

workshop.themilliondollarvsl.com/lesson-1

You'll build two things, in order:

- **Part 1 — The Offer Engine (8 steps).** Everything you figure out before you write a word of copy. Get this right and the copy writes itself.
- **Part 2 — The VSL (13 sections).** The actual sales video script, built section by section from Part 1.

Work top to bottom — don't skip. Each step feeds the next; your customer research in Step 3 is the fuel for almost everything after it. Fill in every blank in your own customer's real words. When you finish, you'll have a complete offer and a complete sales letter.

One rule runs through the whole thing: never invent your customer, and never invent proof. Use real language from real people, and honest results only. That's what makes it convert.

What's inside

Part 1 · The Offer Engine

1. Pick the Core Desire
2. Pick & Validate the Market
3. Customer Research
 - 4/5. Problems & Solutions
6. Name the Vehicle
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8. Package the Deliverables
9. Ad Concepts

Part 2 · The VSL

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The Offer Engine

1 Pick the Core Desire

The emotional reason they actually pull out their wallet.

Why it matters. People don't buy products — they buy the feeling on the other side of the product. Nail the core desire and every line of copy has a target.

THE 10 REASONS PEOPLE BUY

Circle the ones your offer delivers. The strongest offers hit two or three.

- | | |
|--------------------|---------------------|
| 1. Make more money | 6. Get more comfort |
| 2. Save money | 7. Improve health |
| 3. Save time | 8. Gain praise |
| 4. Avoid effort | 9. Be loved |
| 5. Escape pain | 10. Increase status |

YOUR WORKSHEET

MY OFFER HELPS MY CUSTOMER...

CORE DESIRE #1

#2

#3

WHY THEY REALLY WANT THIS

EXAMPLE — AN AI COPYWRITING TOOL

#1 Make more money (better copy → more sales) · #3 Save time (writes it in minutes) · #4 Avoid effort (no hiring a copywriter).

✓ **Done when** you've locked 2–3 core desires.

2

Pick & Validate the Market

Lock the one specific group of people you're selling to.

Why it matters. Gary Halbert's Starving Crowd rule: the #1 advantage in business isn't the product, the copy, or the funnel — it's selling to people who are *starving* for a solution. A great offer to the wrong market dies; a mediocre offer to a starving crowd prints money.

ANSWER THESE 4 — THIS IS YOUR RAW MATERIAL

1. WHO IS THIS FOR? (THE PERSON / AUDIENCE)

2. WHAT PROBLEMS DO YOU THINK THEY HAVE?

3. WHAT DO THEY ULTIMATELY WANT TO ACHIEVE? (THEIR DREAM — NOT THE PRODUCT)

4. WHAT DOES YOUR PRODUCT / SERVICE DO FOR THEM?

SHARPEN IT INTO ONE SPECIFIC PERSON

Turn a vague audience into one self-identifying person — "men" becomes "divorced men over 35 getting back into dating."

MY SHARPENED MARKET

THE 4-POINT GUT-CHECK

- **Spending** — already paying to fix this problem?
- **Reachable** — do they gather in specific places online?
- **Desperate** — a "Googling it at 2 a.m." problem, not a nice-to-have?
- **Growing** — market rising or stable, not dying?

If any answer is weak, niche down or add a pain amplifier until it's strong.

✓ **Done when** you've locked one specific market and it passes the gut-check.

Customer Research

Mine the exact words real people use, from real places.

Why it matters. The most important step — almost every line in your offer and VSL is built from it. Copy from your words, not your imagination.

Where to dig: Reddit, niche forums, YouTube comments, reviews of competing solutions, public Facebook groups. Pull from 4–5 real threads. Mine for language, not facts.

THE FIREWALL

Research the person, not the product. Never write a pain that references your product ("they don't have X"). Mine their real life — the pains, desires and fears they'd have even if you didn't exist.

THE 5 CATEGORIES — FILL EACH WITH REAL QUOTES

😞 **PAINS — WHAT HURTS (WOULD THEY SAY "ARE YOU IN MY HEAD?")**

🚫 **OBJECTIONS — WHY THEY THINK NOTHING WILL WORK**

✨ **DESIRES — THE DREAM OUTCOME (INCL. THE SECRET ONES)**

💣 **FAILURES — WHAT THEY'VE TRIED [THING] — [COST] + [WHY IT FAILED]**

🔥 **MOTIVATIONS — THE DEEPER WHY / WHO THEY'RE DOING IT FOR**

TIME DIMENSIONS

⬅️ **PAST — WHAT GOT THEM HERE**

🕒 **PRESENT — DAILY REALITY NOW**

⏭️ **FUTURE FEARS — IF NOTHING CHANGES**

✅ **POST-SOLUTION — THE NEW IDENTITY**

✓ **Done when** all 5 categories are full of real, sourced quotes + all 4 time dimensions written.



Bonus — The AI Customer-Research Prompt

Want a head start on the research above? Fill in your market, then paste this whole thing into ChatGPT or Claude. It pulls a mountain of research in your customer's own words. Fair warning — it returns a LOT. Don't try to use all of it; just mine the sharpest, most emotional quotes for the boxes above.

You are an elite direct-response customer-research analyst. Build me the deepest possible "voice of customer" research file for the market below, using the real, raw language real people actually use.

MARKET / AVATAR: **[describe your customer in one line – e.g. "beginners trying to make their first \$1,000 selling digital products online"]**

RULES

- Everything must sound like it came from a real person in this market (Reddit, niche forums, YouTube comments, product reviews, Facebook groups). Raw, emotional, first-person. No corporate summaries.
- Do NOT reference or assume any product. Research the PERSON and their real life only.
- Write every item as a short quote or close paraphrase, in their own words, in "quotation marks."
- Hit every minimum below exactly. Do not stop early. If you run low, dig deeper – never pad with fluff.

DELIVER ALL OF THIS:

- 1) PAINS – what hurts (minimum 30).** Group into 6+ sub-themes (money, time, identity/shame, relationships, overwhelm, past failures). For each: the quote + the emotion underneath + the exact moment it hits hardest.
- 2) OBJECTIONS – why they secretly believe nothing will work for THEM (minimum 30).** Split into "I've tried X," "people like me can't," and "it's probably a scam." For each, name the deeper limiting belief.
- 3) DESIRES – the dream outcome (minimum 30),** including the secret/guilty desires they'd never say out loud. For each: the surface want + the real emotional payoff underneath.
- 4) FAILURES – everything they've already tried that flopped (minimum 25).** Format each: [what they tried] – [rough cost/time] – [why they think it failed] – [how it left them feeling].
- 5) MOTIVATIONS – the deeper why (minimum 25):** identity, legacy, family, status, proof, revenge. Who are they really doing this for? What's the 2 a.m. reason?
- 6) TIME DIMENSIONS – 6+ distinct entries for EACH:** PAST (what got them here), PRESENT (daily reality now), FUTURE FEARS (6 months / 2 years / 10 years if nothing changes), POST-SOLUTION (the new identity once it's solved).
- 7) POWER PHRASES (minimum 40):** the most emotionally charged exact phrases from everything above that I could drop word-for-word into ad copy.
- 8) "READ THEIR MIND" LINES (exactly 15):** single sentences that would make this customer freeze and think "are you in my head?"

FORMAT: clear headers, numbered lists, quotes in "quotation marks." Do not summarize or shorten – give me the full volume. Keep going until every single minimum is met.

Problems & Solutions

The pile of named solutions you build here *is* your product.

Map your customer's journey. For each step, surface their four deepest fears — then turn each fear into a named solution.

MAP THE CUSTOMER JOURNEY (5–6 STEPS)

STEP 1

STEP 2

STEP 3

STEP 4

STEP 5

STEP 6

THE NAMED-SOLUTION FORMULA

[Named Solution] — [what it is] so you can [the outcome that solves this fear] even if [their real objection] which means [the deeper payoff].

Dream Outcome = doubt about the destination · Likelihood = doubt about themselves · Time = the wait · Effort = the difficulty.

YOUR WORKSHEET — ONE TABLE PER JOURNEY STEP

Fill one full 4-lens table for each of your 6 journey steps.

JOURNEY STEP 1

Lens	Their fear (their words)	Named Solution (full formula)
Dream Outcome		
Likelihood		
Time		
Effort		

JOURNEY STEP 2

Lens	Their fear (their words)	Named Solution (full formula)
Dream Outcome		
Likelihood		
Time		
Effort		

JOURNEY STEP 3

Lens	Their fear (their words)	Named Solution (full formula)
Dream Outcome		
Likelihood		
Time		
Effort		

JOURNEY STEP 4

Lens	Their fear (their words)	Named Solution (full formula)
Dream Outcome		
Likelihood		
Time		
Effort		

JOURNEY STEP 5

Lens	Their fear (their words)	Named Solution (full formula)
Dream Outcome		
Likelihood		
Time		
Effort		

JOURNEY STEP 6

Lens	Their fear (their words)	Named Solution (full formula)
Dream Outcome		
Likelihood		
Time		
Effort		

✓ **Done when** every journey step has all 4 fears, each paired with one named solution.

6

Name the Vehicle

The new category your offer lives in — "oh, that's different."

Why it matters. The Vehicle quietly implies the old ways failed because they were the wrong category, not because your customer is a failure. It gives them a new identity to buy into.

NAME FORMULA

The [Timeframe] [Dream] [Format]. Format = Blueprint · Challenge · System · Method · Protocol · Roadmap · Formula · Plan. Test: "I'm doing The [name]" should sound like a real product.

MY VEHICLE NAME

SUPERPOWER — WHAT YOUR THING GIVES THEM THAT THE OLD STUFF DOESN'T

POSITIONING — "THE [NAME] IS THE FIRST [CATEGORY] FOR [AUDIENCE]. UNLIKE [OLD WAYS], IT [SUPERPOWER]."

THE 3 SECRETS (BELIEF-BREAKS)

Each kills one doubt. The three objections must be genuinely different; tease the mechanism, don't explain it.

VEHICLE — "HOW TO [DREAM] WITHOUT [FAILURES] EVEN IF [NOTHING WORKS] USING [THE VEHICLE]."

INTERNAL — "HOW TO [DESIRE] WITHOUT [INTERNAL FAILURE] EVEN IF [INTERNAL OBJECTION] WITH [MECHANISM]."

EXTERNAL — "HOW TO [DESIRE] WITHOUT [EXTERNAL FAILURE] EVEN IF [EXTERNAL OBJECTION] WITH [MECHANISM]."

✓ **Done when** you have a name, a positioning line, and 3 distinct secrets — all traced to real earlier steps.

7

The Method

Your 3 secrets flipped from belief into a simple 3-move path.

Why it matters. It makes the buyer think "wait... that's it? I can do that." Simplicity sells.

- 🧠 Internal secret → **Move 1** (an action) · 🌐 External secret → **Move 2** (an action) · 🚗 Vehicle secret → **Move 3** = the dream

THE 7 BEATS — WRITE IT AS A FLOWING SPOKEN SCRIPT

1. *Stakes:* "Right now you're [pain]. And it's hard."
2. *The turn:* "But in the next [timeframe]..."
3. *Move 1:* "You can learn to [outcome] — without [old way]."
4. *Move 2:* "Then, you can learn to [outcome] — without [old way]."
5. *Move 3 = dream:* "And soon, you [dream]."
6. *Even-if:* "And you can do this even if [objection]. Even if [objection]."
7. *Because:* "That's because you follow [the new way] — using [mechanism] and [mechanism] — the same simple system others have used to [result]."

Moves carry outcome + "without" only — no mechanisms in the moves. No brand name. Easy verbs, 3rd-grade, spoken. Never fabricate proof.

WRITE YOUR METHOD

✓ **Done when** you have the full 7-beat spoken script, built from Step 6 (+ Step 3 pains for the opening).

8

Package the Deliverables

Turn your pile of solutions into a stack so valuable the price feels like a steal.

8.1 — THE 3 CORE DELIVERABLES

Cover all 3 beliefs. Pull the existing names — don't re-describe.

 **FLAGSHIP (LEAD-IN, BIGGEST VALUE)**

VALUE \$

 **COMPONENT #2 (INTERNAL MECHANISM)**

VALUE \$

 **COMPONENT #3 (EXTERNAL MECHANISM)**

VALUE \$

8.2 — THE BONUS STACK

The rest of your Step 5 solutions. Keep at least one bonus per journey step.

Bonus name	What it does (Edwards bullet)	Value \$

TOTAL VALUE \$ (AIM 10×+ THE PRICE)

YOUR PRICE \$

✓ **Done when** the full stack (3 core + bonuses) totals 10×+ the price.



Ad Concepts

Modular bricks — Hooks × Meat × CTAs — that combine into ~60 ads.

Treat ads like Lego. You write ~15 pieces; mixing & matching spits out 60 ads. Hooks do 80% of the work.

THE 2 AWARENESS BUCKETS

PROBLEM-AWARE (PAIN-DRIVEN)

SOLUTION-AWARE (PROMISE-DRIVEN)

THE 10 HOOKS — STANDALONE 3-5 SECOND LINES

Problem-aware (from Step 3 pains)	Solution-aware (from Step 6 promise)
1.	6.
2.	7.
3.	8.
4.	9.
5.	10.

THE 2 MEATS (~30-45S BODIES)

MEAT A — PROBLEM-AWARE STORY

MEAT B — SOLUTION-AWARE PROOF / PROMISE

THE 3 CTAS

CTA 1

CTA 2

CTA 3

✓ Done when 2 buckets, 10 hooks, 2 meats & 3 CTAs are written. That completes your Offer Engine — now write the VSL.

The VSL

You write the sales video now. Each section is built from the Offer Engine. Golden rules: 3rd-grade words, conversational (never on-screen bullets), the customer's own language, and each section flows out of the one before it.

1 The Hook

Stop the scroll and make a cold stranger think "wait... how?"

What it does. The very first line of your video. Its only job is to stop them and make them lean in — in one breath.

THE FORMULA

"How to get [dream] without [pain] — even if [objection] — using [your Vehicle]."

Rules. One sentence (two max). Break a belief. Name the new way. Exactly one "even if." Specific beats clever — "Make \$5k/month selling faceless digital products" beats "Unlock your income potential."

YOUR HOOK

2

The Shocking Statement

A pattern-interrupt that snaps them out of autopilot.

What it does. It either challenges a belief they hold, or says out loud the thing they secretly suspect but nobody's said.

PICK A SHAPE

Reframe: "It's not [what they assume] — it's [the surprising real thing]."

Did-you-know: "Did you know [surprising fact they suspect]?"

Stat: "[number] and [zero result]." → "\$7k on ads, zero sales."

Comparison: "You don't [flattering thing] — you [harsher truth]."

Rules. One line (two max). Don't restate the Hook — new angle. Don't fully agitate the pain yet (that's Section 4). Their own language.

YOUR SHOCKING STATEMENT

3

Why — The Desire

Paint the dream so real they feel it. A scene, not a benefit list.

What it does. The magic-wand version of their life, made vivid.

WRITE IT AS A 4-BEAT SCENE

1. *The ordinary moment (Present) — "Imagine waking up, pouring your coffee, checking your phone..."*
2. *The win they see (Desires) — "...three Stripe notifications from people you've never spoken to."*
3. *The freedom (Pains, flipped to "no more...").*
4. *The peak (Motivations + secret Desires) — the identity payoff. End here.*

Rules. Present tense. Sensory. Identity payoffs, not just practical wins. 2–3 short paragraphs. End on the emotional peak.

YOUR DESIRE SCENE

4

Why — The Pain

Agitate the cost of doing nothing. The flip side of Section 3.

What it does. Make where they are, and where it's headed, feel real and urgent. Honest pressure, not manufactured fear.

WRITE IT AS 3 BEATS

1. *The present pain (Pains, in their words). Optional: what they've tried that still failed.*
2. *The cost of staying — pick one: Trajectory (Future fears: 6 months / 2 years) OR FOMO (others pulling ahead, window closing).*
3. *The turning point — "But it doesn't have to stay this way."*

Rules. Be honest — agitate what they already feel. 2–3 short paragraphs. Always end on the turning-point line (the bridge to Section 5).

YOUR PAIN SECTION

5

Introduce the Method

"Okay... so what do I actually DO?" — your 3 dead-simple moves.

What it does. This is your Step 7 Method, beats 2–7 (skip the Stakes — Section 4 already ran the pain).

SAY IT NATURALLY, NOT AS BULLETS

"But in the next [timeframe]... First, you can learn to [Internal outcome] — without [old way]. Then, you can learn to [External outcome] — without [old way]. And soon, you [dream]. And you can do this even if [Internal objection]. Even if [External objection]. That's because you follow [the new way] — using [Internal mechanism] and [External mechanism] — the same system others have used to [the dream]."

Rules. Conversational, never a list. Moves = outcome + "without" only. No brand name or deliverables yet. Even-if = the Internal + External objections only.

YOUR METHOD SECTION

Credibility

The "I was you, then I cracked it" moment that makes them trust you.

What it does. Your real story. Answer these 4 first (a sentence each is plenty).

1. WHO ARE YOU? (FIRST NAME — WRITTEN IN FIRST PERSON)

2. BEFORE THIS WORKED, WHAT WERE YOU DOING? (MIRROR YOUR AUDIENCE'S PAINS)

3. THE TURNING POINT / EPIPHANY THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING (TIE IT TO YOUR VEHICLE)

4. WHAT PROOF DO YOU HAVE? (A SPECIFIC NUMBER, IDEALLY ACROSS MORE THAN ONE PERSON)

THEN WRITE THE TIGHT 3-BEAT STORY

Empathy ("For years, I [did it the way they do now]...") → Discovery ("Then I [cracked / discovered the mechanism]...") → Authority ("And it [big result] — across [range]. So whether you're [avatar], this works.")

First person always. Keep it tight — a short paragraph, not a résumé. Never fabricate proof.

YOUR CREDIBILITY STORY

7

Proof

The "it's not just me" proof — 3 believable testimonials.

What it does. If you don't have real ones yet, write realistic placeholders and swap them later. Blank proof kills a VSL.

FORMAT EACH ONE
[Name], [avatar descriptor] — "[relatable starting point] → [specific result + timeframe], [quick tie to the mechanism]."

Specific beats vague ("4k month" not "great program!"). Believable, not hypey. Cover a range of avatars — each kills a different objection.

TESTIMONIAL 1

TESTIMONIAL 2

TESTIMONIAL 3

Product Overview

"Here's the new opportunity." Name the Vehicle; make them believe.

What it does. Name the Vehicle, position it against the old way, and fold in the 3 belief-breaks (outcome-framed).

THE FILL-IN (FROM YOUR STEP 6 VEHICLE)

"So I created [Vehicle name] — [what it is in one line]. Unlike [the old ways], it [superpower]. Inside, you'll learn to [dream] — even if [nothing works] — with [the simple system]. You'll learn to [Internal outcome] — without [failure] — even if [objection] — with [mechanism]. And you'll learn to [External outcome]... And here's exactly what you get to make that happen..."

Rules. Lean and clean — not the value stack (that's next). Keep belief-breaks outcome-framed. Use the Vehicle name. End on the hand-off.

YOUR PRODUCT OVERVIEW

The Pitch

The offer reveal — "here's exactly what you get."

What it does. Reveal your core offer (from Step 8.1) as 3 tangible deliverables.

THE FORMAT

*"When you join [Vehicle name], you'll get a step-by-step [roadmap / blueprint] to [dream] — without [failures] — even if [nothing's worked]. (Value: \$__ — biggest anchor)
And you'll get... [Internal Name] — [what it is] so you can [outcome], even if [objection], which means [payoff]. (Value: \$__)
[External Name] — ... (Value: \$__)
That's the whole path — and you're not figuring any of it out on your own."*

Rules. The flagship is a tangible roadmap (a thing, not a vague "you'll finally...") carrying the biggest value. Mirror the component bullets & values exactly from Step 8.1. The "even if"s here are micro (deliverable-specific).

YOUR PITCH

Bonuses

Stack the free gifts on top, then do the total-value math.

What it does. Framed as limited and free.

OPEN WITH THE LIMITED / FREE HOOK

"And for the next [30] members who join today, I'm also throwing in these bonuses — completely free:"

Bonus name	One-line benefit → so you can [outcome]	Value \$

GRAND TOTAL \$ (CORE + ALL BONUSES)

AND TODAY, JUST \$

Grand total = core (flagship + both components) + all bonuses. Set a believable member number — that's your scarcity lever.

Guarantee & Urgency

Reverse the risk, then add real urgency.

What it does. Makes buying feel safe AND now. Reversing risk is the #1 lever to lift conversion.

PICK YOUR GUARANTEE TYPE

-  **Unconditional** — "Try it, don't love it, full refund." Best for low-ticket / cold traffic.
-  **Conditional** — "Do the work & if you don't get [result], full refund." Filters tire-kickers.
-  **Anti-guarantee** — "All sales final," + a reason. High-ticket / exclusive only.
-  **Performance** — "If I don't get you the result, I don't get paid." Done-with-you.

NAME YOUR GUARANTEE ("THE 30-DAY LOVE-IT-OR-IT'S-FREE GUARANTEE")

REAL URGENCY — A TRUE DEADLINE, REAL LIMITED SPOTS, OR A REAL PRICE RISE (+ THE REASON WHY)

Urgency must be real. Never fake scarcity.

Tell them exactly what to do.

What it does. The direct, benefit-driven call to action. You need the real price first.

PRICE \$

BUTTON TEXT

LINK

THE FORMULA

"Click the button below to [get Vehicle name] for just \$[price] — and [core benefit from Step 3 Desires]. [One-line nudge to act now.]"

Rules. One clear action. Restate the core benefit (not just "buy now"). Include the price. 1–2 sentences. Use the Vehicle name.

YOUR CTA

The P.S.

The last thing they read — skimmers jump straight here.

What it does. It must stand on its own: restate the dream, the method, and one final nudge. If someone only read the P.S., they'd still want to buy.

THE FORMULA

"P.S. — Remember, [dream outcome] is [timeframe] away. All you need to do is [the method compressed — 3 steps in one breath]. [Urgency / consequence of waiting]."

Rules. Max 3 sentences. Restate the dream AND the method (compressed). End on real urgency (reused from the CTA — don't invent new). Stands alone.

YOUR P.S.

You're done. 🎉

You now have:

- A complete **offer** — core desire, market, deep research, a full problem-to-solution map, a named Vehicle, a simple Method, a stacked offer, and 60 ads ready to film.
- A complete **VSL** — all 13 sections, built from that offer, that reads as one letter top to bottom.

FINAL STEP

Read your VSL out loud, start to finish. If it flows and sounds like a person talking — you're ready to record.